

Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund

DRAFT FOR REVIEW | SCHEME | D010

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The Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development Fund (AHIDF) supports qualifying investment in dairy, meat, animal feed and other specified animal-husbandry infrastructure through a lending and interest-support framework. It is relevant to processing and value addition as well as the other activities expressly identified in the programme.

The Department's Operational Guidelines 3.0 reflect AHIDF's continuation with the Dairy Processing Infrastructure Development Fund incorporated into it. Older FAQs that exclude dairy cooperatives do not describe the full revised applicant scope.

Approval dates and disbursement dates differ

The revised framework states an approval-period endpoint of 31 March 2026. Clause 12.1 allows lenders to disburse for sanctioned projects approved on or before that date, but not beyond 31 March 2027. That later date is a disbursement provision for qualifying approved projects, not evidence of a fresh application window.

The longer programme sunset and repayment periods also serve different purposes. A new applicant needs any subsequent approval authority established before treating AHIDF as available for the proposal. An already approved borrower should check the remaining disbursement conditions and deadline with the lender.

Which projects and applicants fit?

The revised framework identifies dairy and meat processing, animal-feed plants, specified breed-improvement and multiplication activities, veterinary vaccine and drug manufacturing, animal-waste-to-wealth management and primary wool processing. Each category has a defined activity scope. Owning livestock or handling an animal-origin product does not by itself establish eligibility.

Permitted applicant categories include individual entrepreneurs, private companies, MSMEs, FPOs, Section 8 companies and dairy cooperatives, subject to the relevant activity and lending conditions. Establish the applicant, asset and business process together.

What financial support means in practice

The guideline permits loans up to 90% of eligible project cost, based on a viable project and the lender's assessment. Beneficiary contribution varies by enterprise category and financing requirements. The maximum loan share is not a promise that every applicant can contribute only 10%.

Interest assistance follows the applicable programme and sanction terms. The revised document preserves distinctions between earlier AHIDF and DIDF projects, so their historical rates should not be applied indiscriminately to another borrower.

The guideline excludes interest support on borrowing for specified costs, including land, working capital, pre-operative expenditure, existing infrastructure acquisition, old machinery and personal-use vehicles. It also links support to loan performance. Prepare the eligible borrowing schedule separately from the total project and monitor how support is credited to the loan account.

Prepare a project and claim file that agree

The project report should connect raw-material supply, process capacity, product demand, machinery, utilities and financial projections. Assemble applicant and ownership records, land arrangements, technical quotations, permissions, the loan appraisal and financing commitments.

For an approved project, retain the original sanction, programme approval, disbursements, actual expenditure, completion and repayment records. A request to the lender should identify whether the issue concerns disbursement, interest-support credit or a project change. These are different stages with different evidence.

Read the [AHIDF Operational Guidelines 3.0](#) and the [Department's programme overview](#). For a separate processing grant, assess [CEFPPC](#) on its own rules and non-duplication conditions.

Discuss the next step

For help assessing the project and preparing the applicable subsidy work, see [Subsidy & Incentive Advisory](#).

[+91 94672 48028](#)

[Discuss your project](#). An expert consultant from Rapid will call you.

Source links

Links retained from this manuscript. Consult the referenced authority for current requirements; the PDF drafting date does not establish that a source remains current.

1. AHIDF Operational Guidelines 3.0

<https://www.dahd.gov.in/sites/default/files/2026-02/Guidelines3.pdf>

2. Department's programme overview

<https://www.dahd.gov.in/schemes/programmes/ahidf>